TerraAI — Touch Grass

Less Screen Time. More Green Time.

Project README & Documentation

TerraAI is a web-based outdoor activity recommendation project designed to encourage people to disconnect from their screens and reconnect with nature. It helps users discover simple outdoor activities based on their mood, available time, and personal interests.

Built using **HTML, CSS, and JavaScript**, TerraAI explores how open-source AI can make technology more meaningful by encouraging people to spend more time outdoors.

> **Our philosophy:** AI should not keep people on screens longer than necessary. It should help them discover experiences beyond the screen.

1. Project Objectives

- Encourage people to spend more time outdoors.
- Recommend activities based on mood, interests, and available time.
- Explore open-weight AI models in a web application.
- Provide a simple, beginner-friendly user interface.
- Avoid requiring a local AI server such as Ollama.
- Demonstrate how web technologies can support real-world wellbeing and environmental awareness.

2. Features

Personalized Outdoor Activity Planner

Users describe their mood and choose an activity category to receive a suggested outdoor plan.

Open-Source AI Exploration

The project attempts to use Transformers.js with an open-weight model in the browser. If the model cannot load, a built-in JavaScript recommendation system provides a fallback.

Multiple Activity Categories

Walking, gardening, birdwatching, and mindfulness activities help users find an outdoor option.

Flexible Time Selection

Users can select 10, 20, 30, or 60 minutes.

Dark and Light Modes

A theme toggle switches between dark and light appearances.

Responsive Design

The interface is designed to adapt to desktop, tablet, and mobile screens.

No Ollama Installation

The website uses browser technologies and can optionally load an AI model over the internet.

3. Technology Stack

Technology	Purpose
HTML5	Website structure and content
CSS3	Styling, layout, themes, and responsive design
JavaScript	User interactions and recommendation logic
Transformers.js	Browser-based access to supported machine-learning models
Hugging Face model ecosystem	Open-weight models for experimentation

4. Project Structure

```
TerraAI/<br/>■■■ index.html # Main webpage and planner interface<br/>■■■ style.css # Styling,
layout, and dark mode<br/>■■■ script.js # Activity recommendation logic and AI
integration<br/>■■■ README.md # Project documentation
```

index.html: Contains the webpage, input fields, activity selector, and results section.

style.css: Defines colours, typography, layout, responsive behaviour, and themes.

script.js: Handles user input, generates recommendations, and attempts to load the browser-based AI model.

README.md: Explains the project's purpose, features, setup, and development plans.

5. Getting Started

Prerequisites

- A modern browser such as Chrome, Edge, or Firefox.
- Visual Studio Code or another code editor.
- An internet connection for the optional AI model and external dependencies.

No Python installation or Ollama setup is required.

Step 1 — Clone the repository

```
git clone https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME/TerraAI.git
```

Replace YOUR-USERNAME and TerraAI with your actual GitHub username and repository name.

Step 2 — Open the project

```
cd TerraAI<br/>code .
```

Alternatively, open the folder through File → Open Folder in VS Code.

Step 3 — Run the website

- Install the Live Server extension in VS Code if needed.
- Open index.html.
- Right-click inside the editor and select Open with Live Server.
- Your browser should open the TerraAI website.

A local web server is recommended for module loading and browser compatibility. Directly opening index.html may work for basic testing.

6. How the AI Works

Browser-based AI

The application attempts to load a supported model through Transformers.js. Model files are fetched over the internet when needed and processed in the browser where supported. This avoids requiring a separately installed AI server such as Ollama.

Fallback recommendation system

If the AI model cannot load because of network problems, browser limitations, or a model-loading error, the built-in JavaScript recommendation logic can provide a suggestion.

Technical note

Treat the prototype as experimental. The selected model must support the intended Transformers.js task and compatible model files. Verify the model identifier and task before deployment. The fallback system is rule-based or selection-based; it is not itself a generative AI model.

7. Privacy and Data Handling

- Mood and activity inputs are processed by client-side JavaScript.
- No custom application server is required for the basic prototype.
- No personal account is needed to try the planner.
- Loading a model from an external provider involves network requests.
- Browser storage, if used, remains subject to browser settings.

Privacy limitation: The project has not been independently audited. External model downloads and third-party dependencies may contact their providers. Do not enter sensitive personal information.

8. Example Use Case

- A student has been studying on a laptop for several hours and feels mentally tired.
- They enter: “I feel stressed and want to relax.”
- They select 20 minutes and choose walking or let the planner suggest an activity.
- TerraAI provides a simple outdoor activity plan.
- The student steps outside and takes a short break from the screen.

The goal is to make the digital interaction short and the real-world experience the main event.

9. Why Open-Source AI Matters

- **Accessibility:** Experiment with available models without building an AI model from scratch.
- **Flexibility:** Potentially replace the model with another compatible model.
- **Browser-based processing:** Supported inference can run on the user's device instead of requiring a dedicated model server.
- **Lower infrastructure requirements:** A prototype can run without managing a separate backend.
- **Learning:** Explore AI integration using familiar web technologies.

Open-weight models are not automatically free of all restrictions, fully open-source in every respect, or guaranteed to run offline. Check each model's licence and technical requirements before deployment.

10. Future Improvements

- Smarter mood-based activity matching.
- Optional location-aware activity suggestions.
- Local weather and seasonal recommendations.
- Garden planning based on local growing conditions.
- Bird identification using supported audio models.
- Accessibility options and additional languages.
- More activities, including cycling, hiking, and outdoor photography.
- A verified offline mode using compatible downloaded models.
- User testing to assess whether recommendations encourage outdoor activity.
- An AI status indicator showing whether the model or fallback generated the recommendation.

These are planned possibilities, not claims about functionality already implemented.

11. Contributing

Contributions and suggestions are welcome. Fork the repository, create a feature branch, make and test your changes, commit them, push your branch, and open a pull request.

```
git checkout -b feature/your-feature-name<br/>git add .<br/>git commit -m &amp;quot;Add your feature&amp;quot;<br/>git push
```

Describe changes clearly and include screenshots for significant interface updates.

12. Licence

This project can be released under the MIT License. Before publishing, add a LICENSE file containing the MIT License text and confirm that third-party model, library, font, and asset licences permit your intended use. The licence for TerraAI's code does not automatically change the licence of its AI model or dependencies.

13. Author

Created as an open-source AI and web development project.

GitHub: https://github.com/YOUR-USERNAME

Replace the placeholder with your GitHub profile before publishing.

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Technology should connect us with life, not distract us from it. TerraAI explores a simple idea: use AI to inspire people to put their devices down, step outside, and discover the world around them.

#TouchGrass #TerraAI #OpenSourceAI #TransformersJS #HTML #CSS #JavaScript #HuggingFace